

“Combine digital cameras with cell phones... and time is not an issue”

Who: Aijaz Rahi

Field: News and current affairs (South Asia photographer for Associated Press)

His camera: Nikon 1DX: 5.3 megapixels, maximum image size of 3,008 x 1,960 pixels, 2-inch LCD, sensitivity ISO equivalency 125 to 800

Price: Rs 2.9 lakh



Courtesy: Associated Press

Usage: Everyday. Swears by digital photography. Moved to digital photography in 1998 and was one of India's early adopters.

This picture, in his words: The Gateway of India blast in Mumbai redefined new-age terrorism in India. For a news photographer, there are no second chances in such cases. Here, a policeman is surveying a car damaged in the blast that killed 40 people.

Oh, we didn't know: Working for a news-wire service is one of the most demanding jobs in journalism. Since our revenue depends on our clients, and they buy only those pictures that came first, speed is the most important factor. Now, combine digital cameras with cell phones or satellite phones, and time is not an issue anymore.

Memories: In the US-Afghan war, I had to rush to a remote place where a bus carrying children was bombed. I was the only wire photographer there, and if not for my digital camera and satellite phone, covering the calamity would have been impossible.



“I found the moment here... because of the high shutter speed”

Usage: Everyday. Is a devotee of digital photography.

This picture, in his words: I shot this picture during a local school boxing tournament in Mumbai in 2003. Any sports photographer is concerned with only the 'moment'. I found the moment here, but to get it, I had to wait for a long time. But because of the high shutter speed, I could get the moment I was looking for. Moreover, I could see the result immediately, and not wait in suspense until I reached my dark room.

Oh, we didn't know: Digital cameras allow you to experiment a lot, something that is a no-no with traditional cameras, where the cost of experimentation is extremely high.

Next step: I would want to upgrade to a higher-end model such as the Nikon D1X. And then, like any sports photographer, would like to experiment much more than what I am doing right now.



Who: Atul Kamble

Field: Freelance sports photographer (The Hindu, Sportstar, Mid Day)

His camera: Nikon D100: 6.1 megapixels, maximum image size 3,008 x 2,000 pixels, 1.8-inch LCD, top shutter speed 1/4,000 seconds

Price: Rs 1.2 lakh